



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:			Environmental Construction Nuisance		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

If you understand the problems caused by site activities you are in a better position to minimise the impact.

Nuisance causes

- Environmental nuisance is an activity that causes a disturbance.
- The creation of dust, odour, smoke and other emissions may cause health risks to you or to other people near a site.
- Dust can cause damage to vegetation and crops, the wildlife and watercourse.
- Odours and smoke can cause breathing problems when inhaled and lung diseases resulting in a shortening of life.
- Poor housekeeping will help create an environment that can cause a nuisance.

Controlling measures

- Dampen down traffic routes and use wet cutting to reduce the potential for creating dust.
- Minimise dropping heights from a bucket into a haulage vehicle to reduce noise and sheet the loads to reduce the potential for spills and dust.
- Keep to site speed limits and using wheel wash facilities to help reduce noise, ground vibration and dust.
- Well planned and safe storage for materials prevents the additional potential for airborne nuisance.
- Do not ignore complaints. Respond politely and inform your supervisor.
- Most importantly. Monitor activities and report any shortfalls to your supervisors.

Caution measures

- Obtain permission from your supervisor or site manager before having a bonfire.
- If plant is not properly maintained the engine can produce more toxic fumes.

Discussion Points

What can be done to reduce and avoid construction nuisance on site?

Are there any houses or schools near the site that could be affected?